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GOP senator on Epstein files: 'Now I see what the big deal is'

BY ASHLEIGH FIELDS - 02/10/26 10:12 AM ET



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an interview with journalist Pablo Manriquez. "I've sort of intentionally deterred to others to find out about it. But 9-year-old victims ... wow."

"Well, initially, my reaction to all this was, 'I don't care. I don't know what the big deal is.' But now I see what the big deal is, and it was worth investigating," she added. "And the members of Congress that have been pushing this were not wrong. So that's really my only reaction."

The Department of Justice (DOJ) put out its final tranche of files related to Epstein late last month – and several lawmakers were given the chance to view unredacted copies this week.

Reps. Thomas Massie (R-Ky.) and Ro Khanna (D-Calif.) have led the charge to uncover more details related to the disgraced financier's wealthy circle of businessowners and who may have been involved with his crimes – including allegations of running a sex trafficking ring involving underage girls. Epstein died by suicide in jail in 2019 while awaiting trial on those charges.

The lawmakers, after reviewing the files, said they spotted at least six names of people "likely incriminated" by their inclusion in the Epstein files.

Over the weekend, Epstein survivors also launched a renewed push for additional documents to be released, accusing the Trump administration of concealing more than 3 million documents.

An ad that aired during the Super Bowl on Sunday shows cameos of different survivors, with a collective voiceover stating, "After years of being ripped apart, we are standing together. Because this girl deserves the truth. Because we all deserve the truth."

Deputy Attorney General Todd Blanche has defended the administration's handling of the files, while acknowledging that most people would not be satisfied by the information contained inside the documents.

"There's a hunger or a thirst for information that I do not think will be satisfied by the review of these documents and ... there's nothing I can do about that," Blanche said last month.

"There's this built-in assumption that somehow there's this hidden tranche of information of men that we know about, that we're covering up, or that we're choosing not to prosecute," he continued at the time. "That is not the case."

"I don't know whether there are men out there that abuse these women. If we learn about information and evidence that allows us to prosecute them, you better believe we will," the

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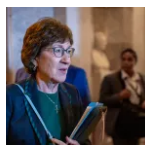
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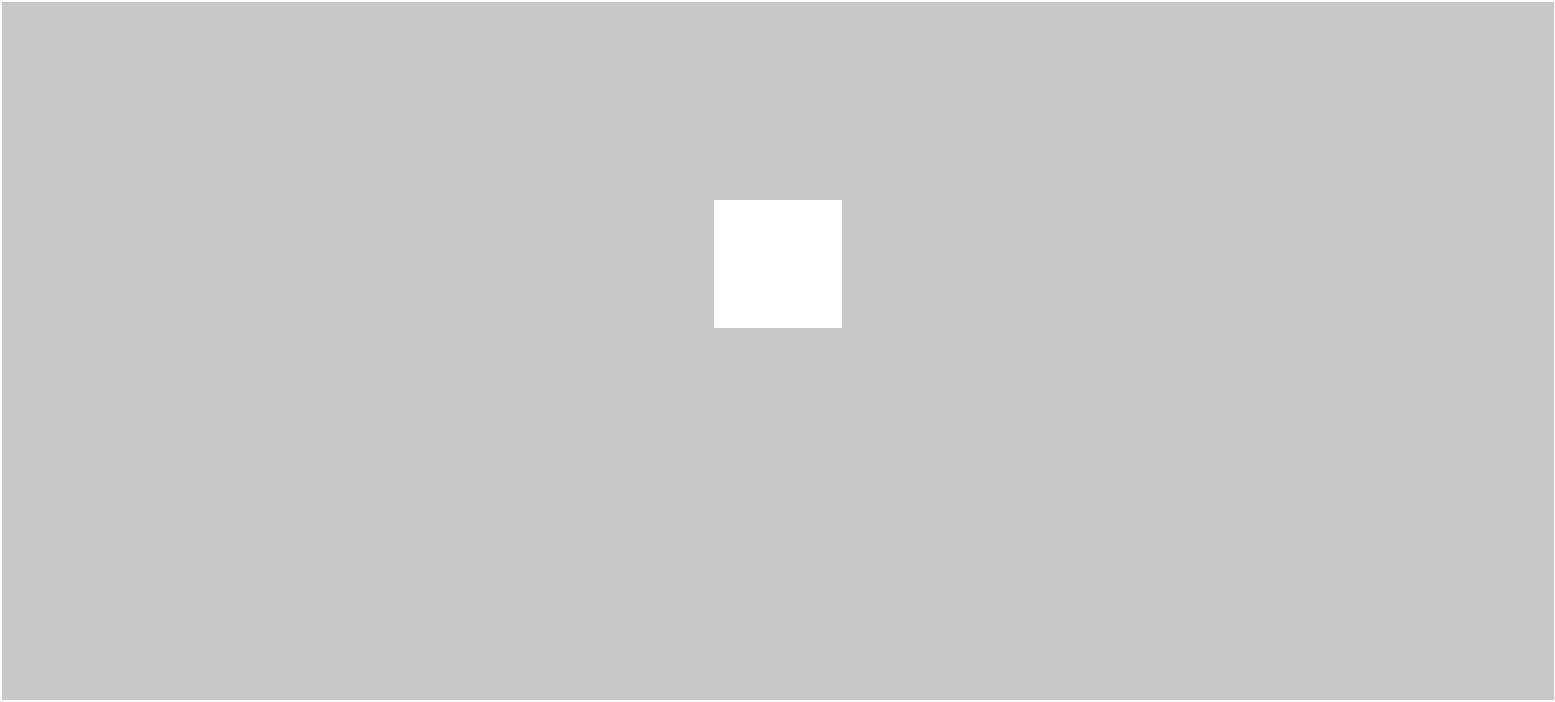


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